

### 1. I patched iotop for better disk benchmarks on modern macOS

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 20:32:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/i-patched-iotop-for-better-disk-benchmarks-on-modern-macos/>

A decade ago, I settled on iotop for disk benchmarking on all my systems. Tools like fio ('Flexible IO' tester) are a little more capable for raw disk performance testing, and other tools test network-scale filesystems better, but iotop gives me an easy overview of real-world disk performance across hard drives and SSDs, and runs on Mac, Windows, and Linux (and a smattering of other OSes). It's been around since 1991, and is still updated today?in fact, the two latest updates (version 509 and 510) contain patches I sent in to get iotop to compile on Apple Silicon Macs running newer releases of macOS.

### 2. The pressure

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-26T23:48:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/26/the-pressure/#atom-everything>

The pressure Daniel Stenberg on the unprecedented level of pressure the curl team are facing right now thanks to the deluge of (credible) AI-assisted security issues being reported. The rate of incoming security reports is 4-5 times higher than it was in 2024 and double the speed of 2025 -- meaning that on average we now get more than one report per day. The quality is way higher than ever before. The reports are typically very detailed and long. [...] For the first time in my life, my wife voiced concerns about my work hours and my imbalanced work/life situation. I work more than I've done before, but the flood keeps coming. [...] This is a never-before seen or experienced pressure on the curl project and its security team members. An avalanche of high priority work that trumps all other things in the project that is primarily mental because we certainly could ignore them all if we wanted, but we feel a responsibility, we have a conscience and we are proud about our work. The good news is that curl is a very solid piece of software, so the vulnerabilities people are finding tend not to be of high severity: What is also a good trend: almost no one finds terrible vulnerabilities....

### 3. Microsoft Copilot Cowork Exfiltrates Files

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-26T15:36:48+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/26/copilot-cowork-exfiltrates-files/#atom-everything>

Microsoft Copilot Cowork Exfiltrates Files The biggest challenge in designing agentic systems continues to be preventing them from enabling attackers to exfiltrate data. In this case Microsoft Copilot Cowork (yes, that's a real product name) was allowing agents to send emails to the user's own inbox without approval... but those messages were then displayed in a way that could leak data to an attacker via rendered images: Because these messages can contain external images that trigger network requests to external websites, data can be exfiltrated when a user opens a compromised message sent by the agent. Since OneDrive can create pre-authenticated download links, a successful prompt injection could cause those links to be leaked, allowing files to be downloaded by the attacker. Via Hacker News Tags: microsoft, security, ai, prompt-injection, generative-ai, llms, exfiltration-attacks, lethal-trifecta

### 4. Quoting Paul Graham

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-26T15:02:30+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/26/paul-graham/#atom-everything>

A lot of the emails I get from founders are now written in a hard-hitting journalistic style. I know they're written by AI, because no founder ever wrote this way before. And once you realize something is written by AI, it's hard not to ignore it. I have never knowingly finished reading an email signed by a human but written by AI. It feels like being lied to, and who would stand for that? [...] It makes me think less of the author. It means they can't write well unaided

(or feel they can't), and that they're trying to trick me. It's not impressive to use AI to write stuff for you; any teenager can do that. ? Paul Graham Tags: writing , ai-misuse , paul-graham , generative-ai , ai , llms

#### 5. How Many Tokens Did You Burn Today

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Wed, 27 May 2026 00:31:22 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/how-many-tokens-did-you-burn-today?src=feed>

Early in my career, a manager at one of the big firms where I worked made a request so absurd it remains etched in my memory. I walked back to the team, repeated what he had asked, and couldn't finish the story without laughing. He wanted me to create a pie chart, of lines of code, per developer, per week. We all lost it. Our lead developer asked if, by any chance, the manager's eyes looked glassy. We laughed even harder. Because yes. Yes, they did. He was always high. That was twenty years ago. I've repeated that story countless times, and it always drew chuckles as we discussed the disconnect between software teams and management. Any software engineer could relate. We all knew that lines of code were a meaningless metric. A junior could write a thousand lines of spaghetti. A senior could fix the same problem with forty elegant ones. But then, last week, I found my name at the top of a leaderboard. My employer had been exploring productivity tools and trialed one they thought would be useful. After the trial, they were quoted \$500k a year. The tool tracked developer productivity and integrated with Atlassian products, Microsoft, and many other services we used. The price was too...

#### 6. Amber Alert sends Spam URL?

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 03:25:17 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/byte-size/amber-alert-with-spam-link?src=feed>

Well that was weird. I just received an Amber Alert and the link led to a spammy looking website. Spam? The link leads to a 3gp file converter which is highly unusual. But the more I look at it, I have the impression it's a mistake. Most likely, they have exceeded the maximum number of characters for the Emergency Service alert. Here is the message: AN AMBER ALERT HAS BEEN ACTIVATED BY THE CALIFORNIA HIGHWAY PATROL. DALEZA FREGOSO WAS LAST SEEN ON MAY 24, 2026 AT 0400 HOURS IN LOS ANGELES COUNTY. THE SUSPECT VEHICLE IS A WHITE 2019 WHITE LAND ROVER DISCOVERY CA 9DAW715. CLICK ON THE LINK FOR ADDITIONAL INFORMATION. <https://bit.ly/A0> It seems like the total character count is 288. I'm not sure if the title should be included but if I add Child abduction (Amber alert) and the double space after, then we have 320 characters. Is this the character limit for emergency services? When I clicked on it, it took me to the bitly preview page: And clicking on the continue to destination button, I'm taken here: Suspicious Link I was starting to wonder if this was even a real Amber alert, and if somehow this was a spam message that was sent through. But unfortunately, it is a real amber alert,...

#### 7. Trump Mobile Website Exposed the Number of Pre-Orders ? Both Completed and Abandoned ? and the Associated Customer Information

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-25T18:54:37Z

Link: <https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/may/23/trump-mobile-investigating-potential-exposure-of-would-be-customers-personal-information>

Catie McLeod, The Guardian: Trump Mobile said in a statement that it was investigating the issue ? ?with the assistance of independent cybersecurity professionals? ? in which the full names, addresses and phone numbers of people who filled out preorder forms appeared to be exposed. [...] Jonathan Soma, a programmer and professor at New York's Columbia University, reviewed the code that the Australian had uncovered and copied from the Trump Mobile website. Soma said the website used a common e-commerce model, in which every potential order added another ?1? to a list, the total of which had reached 27,224 possible pre-orders on the available information. But he said the code reflected the last step before payment, meaning those who didn't proceed with the purchase were also recorded in the data, even those people who have abandoned their carts without paying the deposit, so the true number of preorders was

likely to be even lower. ?I probably started three phone purchases and didn't buy any of them,? he said. Auric Goldfinger is surely rolling over in his grave. ?

#### 8. The History of ?OK?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-25T17:18:56Z

Link: <https://www.merriam-webster.com/wordplay/the-hilarious-history-of-ok-okay>

Merriam-Webster: The 1820s and 1830s shared another linguistic fad with today: an appreciation for deliberate misspellings. (Kewl, rite?) This trend, which had humorists adopting now-creaky bumpkin personas with ignorance manifested in uneducated spellings, turned no go into know go and no use into know yuse (lol). Abbreviations were not immune, and no go became K.G. . So too all right became O.W. , as an abbreviation for oll wright . And all correct became o.k. , as an abbreviation for oll korrekt . Although OK became one of the more commonly used initialisms, it might have passed into oblivion when the linguistic fad had passed if not for the presidential election of 1840, when Martin Van Buren was given the nickname of ?Old Kinderhook? because of his hometown of Kinderhook, NY. The Van Buren stans who joined ?OK Clubs? nationwide were themselves, they proclaimed, ?OK.? Their campaign was memorable enough to have both popularized the word and to have hijacked the story of its origin: there are today still those who believe that ?Old Kinderhook? is the original meaning of OK . I have a strong preference for OK (perhaps infused by the classic Macintosh Human Interface Guidelines...

#### 9. WorkOS: ?Agents Need Context. Ship the Integrations That Give It to Them.?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-25T15:09:17Z

Link: [https://workos.com/docs/pipes?utm\\_source=daringfireball&utm\\_medium=newsletter&utm\\_campaign=q22026](https://workos.com/docs/pipes?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q22026)

My thanks to WorkOS for once again sponsoring DF last week. The context that actually matters isn't in your database. It's in the tools your users live in every day. Multi-stage agents stall the moment they hit a step they can't see. And every missing integration is a different OAuth flow, a different token lifecycle, weeks of plumbing before the agent reads a single record. WorkOS Pipes connects your agent to the tools your users live in. Pre-built connectors for GitHub, Slack, Salesforce, Google Drive, and more. Pipes handles OAuth, token refresh, and credential storage. You call the real provider API with a fresh token, every time. Your agent pulls context at every step, for as long as the task runs. Give your agent context. ?

#### 10. If C# and JavaScript lets me await a Windows Runtime asynchronous operation more than once, why not C++/WinRT?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260526-00/?p=112354>

A difference in philosophy. The post If C# and JavaScript lets me await a Windows Runtime asynchronous operation more than once, why not C++/WinRT? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

#### 11. A hypothetical redesign of System.Diagnostics.Process to avoid confusion over properties that are valid only when you are the one who called Start

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 25 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260525-00/?p=112351>

Putting them in a place that can access only if you call Start . The post A hypothetical redesign of System. Diagnostics. Process to avoid confusion over properties that are valid only when you are the one who called Start appeared first on The Old New Thing .

#### 12. Is ?colorectal cancer? rising in ?young people??

Source: DYNAMIGHT | Published: 2026-05-26T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://dynamight.net/crc-rates/>

(Yes, but.) Over the past few years, I've seen many articles about mysterious rise in colorectal cancer (CRC) in young people. There are various stories for why this might be happening: General health. Maybe modern people are unhealthy (obesity, low physical activity, diabetes, poor sleep), leading to insulin resistance and chronic inflammation, meaning faster

epithelial cell proliferation and a miscalibrated immune system that fails to stop early cancers? Ultra-processed food. Maybe people are eating more ultra-processed foods that contain additives (like emulsifiers) that degrade colon mucus, allowing bacteria to contact epithelial cells and drive inflammation? Or maybe ultra-processed food has low fiber and glycemic load, leading to insulin resistance and chronic inflammation, with the problems mentioned above? Bad meat. Maybe people are eating more red and/or processed meats, which expose the colon to nitrites and secondary bile acids, which inflame the epithelium and promote chronic inflammation? The microbiome. Maybe it's the microbiome. For example, maybe people's guts are getting colonized by strains of *E. coli* that produce genotoxic colibactin. Or maybe overuse of antibi...

### 13. Clanker: A Word For The Machine

Source: Armin Ronacher's Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-05-26T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/5/26/clankers/>

In my last post I used the word "clanker" as an alternative to "agent" quite consistently and probably excessively. That choice ended up attracting a lot more attention than I expected in the Hacker News comment section of that post and a number of folks had a very strong reaction: to them it sounded like a slur, in one case even something adjacent to the n-word. That reaction surprised me somewhat, but it also made me realize that I should write down what I mean by the word for future reference. For me "clanker" is useful because it creates distance from the machine and that is a quality which is important to me. The machine is not a person, not a co-worker, not a friend, not a little spirit in the terminal. It is just a machine, a tool, and nothing more. Why Not Agent? I dislike the word "agent" for these LLM based tool loops with a UI attached. In everyday use an agent is someone who acts on behalf of someone else and it has agency and more importantly: responsibility. An agent decides, represents, negotiates, acts, and can be blamed. In the current AI discourse we increasingly do a lot of anthropomorphizing and the term "agent" is now frequently being used to put blame on an a...

### 14. Calculating the expected range of normal samples

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 17:59:53 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/26/calculating-expected-normal-range/>

The previous post looked at the expected IQ range in a jury of 12. This post will look more generally at computing the expected range of  $n$  samples from a  $N(0, 1)$  random variable. This will give the expected range in units of  $\sigma$ , i.e. multiply the results by  $\sigma$  if your  $\sigma$  isn't 1.

As mentioned [?] The post Calculating the expected range of normal samples first appeared on John D. Cook .

### 15. Expected IQ spread on a jury

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 13:50:51 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/26/expected-iq-spread-on-a-jury/>

There's been some discussion online lately about how a large difference in IQ makes it difficult for two people to communicate. There have been studies that confirm this effect. The difficulty is not insurmountable, but it takes deliberate effort to overcome. Someone dismissed this communication difficulty by pointing out that the expected difference in IQ [?] The post Expected IQ spread on a jury first appeared on John D. Cook .

### 16. The Great Depopulation

Source: Derek Thompson | The Atlantic | Published: 2026-05-26T07:00:00-04:00

Link:

[https://www.theatlantic.com/ideas/2026/05/global-birthrate-decline/687297/?utm\\_source=feed](https://www.theatlantic.com/ideas/2026/05/global-birthrate-decline/687297/?utm_source=feed)

This article was featured in the One Story to Read Today newsletter. Sign up for it here. Why has the number of births declined everywhere, all at once? Some blame technology, particularly smartphones and social media. Others blame a kind of 21st-century weltanschauung—a sadness about the state of the world and our uncertain future in it. A long essay in The New York Times by Anna Louie Sussman, titled "Why So Few Babies? We Might Have Overlooked the Biggest Reason of

All ,? argues that today?s generation is too anxious about the future to make the irreversible commitment of having a child. So who is right? Is this about phones and technology, or is it a reflection of modern anxiety about the world? Or, perhaps, both? Birth rates have been declining in developed countries for a long time, as child mortality has declined, as women?s education has increased, as female labor-force participation has soared, as contraception use has proliferated, and as modern notions of feminism have empowered women to take more control over their bodies and their economic futures. And birth rates have continued to decline as smartphone usage has surged, as housing prices have increased, as time spent...

#### 17. Pluralistic: The AI bubble isn't like the internet bubble (26 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 09:45:37 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/26/the-ai-will-continue/>

Today's links The AI bubble isn't like the internet bubble: No one had to force-feed the web to workers. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Website graveyard; Anti-librarian witch-hunt; Denmark v Marmite; The unnecessariat. Upcoming appearances: London, Kansas City, LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. The AI bubble isn't like the internet bubble (permalink) One of the surprise breakout software products of the early web was Lotus Notes, a kind of primitive precursor to all-in-one office productivity suites like GDocs, Office365, etc. It was so important that its creator, Ray Ozzie, was promoted to Microsoft's Chief Software Architect, succeeding Bill Gates himself: <https://knowledge.wharton.upenn.edu/podcast/knowledge-at-wharton-podcast/the-man-who-would-change-microsoft-ray-ozzies-vision-for-connected-software/> People who remember Notes tend to deride it for its clunky user interface and demi-functional administrative tools. But what made Notes so central to Microsoft wasn't its pol...

#### 18. The mysterious Hy3 LLM is topping OpenRouter Model Rankings by a large margin

Source: Max Woolf's Blog | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 08:30:00 -0700

Link: <https://minimaxir.com/2026/05/openrouter-hy3/>

Why Hy3?

#### 19. Revenge of The Business Idiot

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 16:47:30 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/the-revenge-of-the-business-idiot/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter. It's \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA , Anthropic and

#### 20. 90 % of the t distribution

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/ninety-percent-of-the-t-distribution>

William Sealy Gosset was great. He improved beer at Guinness by using the statistics that existed at the time. Not happy with that, he invented new statistics to brew even better beer. The things he invented are used all over the place now, but Guinness wanted to keep him a secret weapon, so they made him publish his results under the fake name Student . One thing Gosset realised is that it is wrong to compute 90 % confidence intervals for the mean by taking the standard deviation of the sample, and assume a normal distribution , like-a-so:  $\hat{\mu} \pm 1.645 \hat{\sigma}$  (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

#### 21. Copying Remote Command Output to Your macOS Clipboard

Source: IT Notes | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 09:00:00 +0000

Link:

<https://it-notes.dragas.net/2026/05/26/copying-remote-command-output-to-your-macos-clipboard/>

I use Apple devices very often. Overall, I like macOS. Certainly more than Windows. One of the things I find extremely useful is a command I discovered not too long ago: `pbcopy`. `pbcopy` can be used to copy to the clipboard whatever it receives from standard input. For example, when I am in a shell, I often use a command like this: `cat filename.md | pbcopy`. At that point I know that the content of the file is in the clipboard, and I can paste it wherever I need, calmly and without any additional steps. There is one limitation, though: this only works locally. It works when I am using my Mac and I want to copy something from the macOS shell. When I connect to a remote (\*BSD, Linux, illumos based) server via ssh, `pbcopy` is not available. Or, more precisely, even if I create a command with the same name on the server, that command cannot directly talk to the clipboard of my Mac in the usual way. Luckily, modern terminal emulators have a few tricks available. I use iTerm2 for most of my ssh sessions and, once I realised how useful it would be to have something similar to `pbcopy` in remote sessions too, I created a small script that works both on Linux, the BSDs and illumos based OSes. Th...

## 22. Only insane people use the internet

Source: Experimental History | Published: Tue, 26 May 2026 16:02:14 GMT

Link: <https://www.experimental-history.com/p/only-insane-people-use-the-internet>

OR: hit me with your Honda

## 23. Is biology too complex to ever understand?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 07 Dec 2019 14:53:42 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/biologists-physics-envy/>

Note: This article covers a lot of well-trodden ground, although this post has the benefit of 1) being rather brief and 2) advancing slightly on from earlier work. Noam Chomsky wrote 39 dense pages of philosophy on this subject in "Mysteries of Nature: How Deeply Hidden?". Evolutionary's leading light Ernst Mayr wrote a whole book called "What makes biology unique?". Finally, a lot of this thinking is also covered in the quite philosophical work "The way of the Cell" by Franklin M.

## 24. Dear anonymous internet user asking for help..

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 02 Dec 2019 13:09:45 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/anonymous-help/>

Dear anonymous internet user, dear corporate employee hiding behind a gmail.com address, dear "GitHub account with a single issue?", Thank you for your interest in my free software, my project or the documentation I wrote for you. I am happy to hear you want to ask a question, have a problem, or perhaps even inform me of a new requirement you have. But with some small exceptions (do read on), I'm afraid I will not be able to help you.

## 25. State of the world: The Real Data

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 24 Nov 2019 13:57:21 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/the-real-data/>

This page collects links to raw and live sources on how well the planet, including its vital infrastructure, is doing right now, potentially visualised attractively. But the key thing is, we want Real Data, from the most direct sources. Sources are expected to be realtime or at least updated frequently. Mere estimates of things based on questionable inputs are explicitly not welcome, no matter how pretty their output. Please submit new links or fixes to @bert\_hu\_bert or bert@hubernet.